

Aegis Futures Lab — User Manual

For traders, not technicians. Everything you need to use the app, in plain language.

Live app: <https://aegis-futures-lab-khaki.vercel.app> This manual is also available inside the app on the **Guide** page.

1. What this app is

Aegis watches the two micro futures markets — **MES** (Micro E-mini S&P 500) and **MNQ** (Micro E-mini Nasdaq-100) — and posts **practice trade ideas** two to three times a day using a demand-and-supply zone strategy. Every idea is tracked to its result (target hit, stop hit, or closed flat), so you can judge the strategy on evidence instead of memory.

Nothing here touches real money. There is no broker connection, prices are delayed 10–15 minutes, and trade ideas appear 5–15 minutes after the setup happens. Use the app to practice, learn, and keep score — never as a live trade instruction.

2. Your daily routine

1. **Open Home with your morning coffee.** It is the screen the app starts on and it answers the whole morning in one look: how many ideas today (the dots fill toward the 2–3 per day target), today's profit or loss, when the bot checks next, and — at the top — the one idea that is live right now, with its entry, stop and target. If nothing is running, it says so plainly.
2. **Scroll on for the last three weeks.** One bar per trading day, green above the line and red below, with the net, the win rate and the number of ideas beside it. Below that: the two markets, the zones price is closest to, and whether the bot is healthy.
3. **Open Signals when you want the detail.** Every idea ever posted, grouped by day. Each row is a complete trade plan: where to get in (Entry), where the idea is wrong (Stop), where to take profit (Target), and how it ended (the Status badge).
4. **Glance at the Zone watchlist.** These are the buy and sell areas the strategy cares about, sorted by how close price is. An amber **AT ZONE** badge means price is sitting in one right now — the interesting moments happen there.
5. **After you trade, write it down.** On the Journal page, add your own trades by hand or import the CSV file your broker (Topstep / Tradovate) exports. The journal saves to the cloud automatically.
6. **On the weekend, keep score.** The Performance panel shows the win rate and running profit of each tier. Give the engine a few weeks of evidence before drawing conclusions — a handful of trades proves nothing, in either direction.

3. Tier A and Tier B — the two kinds of ideas

- **TIER A** — the classic zone setup: price returning to a fresh Daily or 4-hour demand/supply zone with everything lined up. These are **rare** (sometimes none for days) but they are the highest-conviction trades the strategy knows.

- **TIER B** — the daily bread-and-butter: a mean-reversion setup that fades short-term exhaustion, capped at two trades per market per day and shut off after two losses. These keep the feed active every day.

The point of the labels: over time, watch **which tier actually makes money** in the Performance panel, and weight your attention accordingly.

4. How to read one signal

Field	Meaning
Entry / Stop / Target	The full plan. Risk = entry to stop; reward = entry to target.
R:R	Reward-to-risk. 1.5 means the target pays 1.5× what the stop costs — you only need to win about 4 in 10 to come out ahead.
Status	TARGET = winner · STOP = loser · OPEN = still running · FLAT CLOSE = closed at 15:25 ET / 00:55 IST (the strategy never holds overnight).
P&L	Simulated dollars for the position size the engine chose (risking about \$160 per trade), commissions already subtracted.
Regime	What kind of market the idea was born into: trending or ranging, quiet or volatile (e.g. TR·HV = trending, high volatility). It never changes the ideas — it is a label, so the Performance panel can show which conditions the strategy actually earns in.

5. What each page does

Page	What it's for
Home	The screen the app opens on. Today at a glance: the live idea, today's score, the last three weeks, the two markets, the nearest zones, and whether the bot is healthy.
Signals	Every idea, grouped by day, with the full zone watchlist and engine detail.
Markets	Delayed charts, a live strategy readout, and the news calendar — each week's high-impact U.S. events from a free live feed, backed by the official BLS and Fed schedules when the feed is down.
Journal	Pick any past day: see what the engine did, minute by minute, next to your own journaled trades. This is where the learning happens.
Strategy Lab	The workshop (advanced, optional). Change strategy settings and run backtests.
Compare / Data	More of the workshop — compare variants, load your own CSV history. Both sit under More in the side menu on a computer. The Data page also shows the app's own price archive: it saves its five-minute history to the cloud every day, so over time backtests can reach further back than the feed's 60-day limit.
Guide	The in-app version of this manual.

You never need the workshop pages to follow the signals.

6. ET or IST — your choice

Every time in the app can be shown on the New York exchange clock (**ET**) or on your own clock in India (**IST**). Use the **ET / IST** switch — bottom of the side menu on a computer, top right on a phone. The choice is remembered on that device and it changes every screen at once: signal times, the chart's time axis, the journal, the news calendar.

Two things deliberately do **not** move:

- **Trading days.** The blotter groups ideas by New York trading day, always. An idea posted at 21:20 IST belongs to that New York session, not to the next Indian date.
- **Journal entry times.** You type your own trades in ET, because that is what the chart and the engine's own timestamps use. When the app is set to IST, the form shows what your typed ET time means in IST as you go.

India does not change its clocks but the United States does, so the gap is 9½ hours from March to November and 10½ hours through the winter. The app works this out for you — the session rules always print both, like "flat by 15:25 ET (00:55 IST)", and that second figure shifts by itself when New York changes its clocks.

7. Put it on your phone

Open the site on your phone, then choose **Add to Home Screen** in the browser menu. It installs like an app and opens straight onto the Home screen, with the five main pages along the bottom.

8. Words you'll see

Word	Meaning
Zone	A price area where big buying (demand) or selling (supply) showed up before. The strategy trades the return to these areas.
Fresh / Tested	Fresh = price hasn't come back to the zone yet (strongest). Tested = touched once already.
Paper trading	Practice trades with imaginary money. All trades in this app are paper trades.
Flat by 15:25 ET	The strategy closes everything before the New York session ends (00:55 IST in summer, 01:55 in winter). No overnight risk, ever.
Engine (the "bot")	The automated checker that re-reads the market every 15 minutes during London and New York hours. If Home or Signals says the bot is idle or a run failed, the feed is paused — not the market.
Win rate	Share of closed trades that made money.
Delayed data	Prices arrive 10–15 minutes late. Fine for studying, useless for live execution.
ET / IST	The two clocks the app can show. ET is New York exchange time — the clock the strategy is written in.

9. If something looks wrong

- **"Data delayed more than usual"** — an amber note on Home (Bot status) and on the Signals heartbeat. The bot is running, but the prices it last saw are older than the usual 10–15 minutes (a slow feed or a missed check during market hours). Ideas simply catch up on the next pass — treat the current ones as extra-delayed.
 - **"Bot idle" on Home / "Engine idle / stale" on Signals** — the scheduled checker missed its slot (it runs on a free scheduler that is sometimes 5–15 minutes late). It catches up on the next pass; nothing is lost, because every pass recomputes the full picture.
 - **"Nothing open right now" on Home** — normal. Most of the day there is no live idea; the card tells you when the bot checks next.
 - **No signals today** — quiet days happen, especially for Tier A. The pace dots simply stay empty. That is information too.
 - **"Signal feed unreachable"** — your device is offline or the database is briefly unavailable. The page retries every minute on its own.
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Manual version: matches the app as of 2026-07-23. If the app has changed since, the Guide page in the app is the up-to-date reference (this file is regenerated from it — see CLAUDE.md in the repository).